Rohini and me, this is the time to pay back to society for all that we have got in life.

Three generations of my family climbed eighteen rungs of the military ladder, from that of a soldier to that of a four-star general. It has been a century of service to the nation and the army. Whenever I hear the sound of the bugle, grandpa's face flashes in my mind, and his words resonate. 'When one's path is righteous and the cause is just, one will always be crowned with success.' And, 'sepoy da beta karnail, ate karnail da beta jarnail banega' (the soldier's son shall be a colonel, and the colonel's son will be a general). We were blessed to have had loving and caring parents. Rohini has been a wonderful companion and has played an invaluable part in this success story, and Vivek and Sonia have been adorable children. Life together, with its ups and downs, has been exciting and pleasurable. A lot has changed in the period between 1914 and 2012, but the core values and the bravery, courage, discipline and steadfastness of the Indian army soldier have not changed. An everlasting salute to my jawans is my modest acknowledgement.

In the end spirit always conquers the sword.

– Napoleon

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[1] *India Empowered*, excerpts from my article that appeared in the *Indian Express*, 3 September 2005.

[2] Ronald Lewin, *Slim*, Leo Cooper Ltd, 1990, p. 137.

[3] Centre for Armed Forces Historical Research, 2007, *The Indian Army: An Illustrated Overview*, p. 248.